Farrukhabad, the nearest railway station (NRS) on the broad-gauge line, from where it was a forty-five-minute drive to the Sikh Light Infantry Regimental Centre (SLIRC).

Fatehgarh is a small cantonment on the Southern bank of the River Ganga, housing besides the SLIRC, the Rajput Regimental Centre (RRC) and a Territorial Army Battalion. The SLIRC was not always in Fatehgarh, having moved there only in 1977. Earlier, it used to be at Meerut, along with the Punjab and Sikh Regimental Centres and the Remount Veterinary Centre and School. As a fallout of the 1971 war, it was decided that administrative units such as training centres should be moved to the hinterland and operational formations—Divisions and Brigades—moved closer to the border for faster mobilization. Fatehgarh was chosen for the SIKH LI because, during British times, the Sikh Pioneers (the forebears of the SIKH LI) had once camped at the Fatehgarh Fort. The RRC was not too happy with this development, since they had to share their barracks and training areas with the SLIRC and could no longer rule the roost. The initial few years were quite acrimonious, with the Commandants not on talking terms, but with changes at the top as part of routine turnover, relations improved, though a strong competitive spirit and professional rivalry persisted.

The Commandant of the Centre was Brig KM Tewari, who had also commanded Lucky Seven. I had heard many tales about him right from my NDA days when he was the Battalion Commander of No. 2 Battalion, as well as in the unit. He was an extremely sharp officer and nothing escaped his attention. After the customary interview, I went and reported to Col Moti Singh, the CO of the Training Battalion. One of the first things I told him was about Veena being in the family way and put in my request for some leave in March, which

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